"I'm dumb."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Struggles with reading, math, attention, or processing can bring years of corrections, low grades, and comparisons. Labels like "slow" or "lazy" stick, and many carry the word "dumb" into adulthood.

What Scripture teaches

"God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong." "Not many of you were wise by human standards." Peter and John were "unschooled, ordinary men" whose boldness amazed people because "they had been with Jesus" (Acts 4:13). God gives each person different gifts, and "to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good." Learning differences are real, and they say nothing about your worth or your intelligence in other areas.

> *"But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong"* (1 Corinthians 1:27).

Also see

> "Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good" (1 Corinthians 12:7).

> "When they saw the boldness of Peter and John and realized that they were unschooled, ordinary men, they marveled and took note that these men had been with Jesus" (Acts 4:13).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "Just as each of us has one body with many members, and not all members have the same function, so in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another. We have different gifts according to the grace given us. If one's gift is prophecy, let him use it in proportion to his faith" (Romans 12:4–6).

Common self-statements

- I was born stupid.
- Everybody is smarter than me.
- I cannot do school.
- I will always fail.
- Teachers gave up on me.
- I am an idiot.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either smart or dumb.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always fail.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling slow and concluding I am dumb.
- Labeling: Calling myself dumb.

Challenging questions

- Who first called me dumb, and what did they know about me?

- What am I good at?
- How do I learn best?
- What help or accommodations exist?
- What does Scripture say about God's choices?
- Who sees my gifts?

Truth summary

> I am not dumb. I learn differently, I have gifts, and God uses people of all abilities. I can find the help and methods that fit me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride
- Humility
- Gifts, Physical/Material
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm dumb"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm dumb." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who first called me dumb, and what did they know about me?
- ☐ What am I good at?
- ☐ How do I learn best?
- ☐ What help or accommodations exist?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's choices?
- ☐ Who sees my gifts?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God chose the weak and foolish things.
- ☐ Ordinary people with Jesus do remarkable things.
- ☐ I have gifts for the common good.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ I learn differently.
- ☐ I can get help.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 1:27
  "But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:7
  "Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good."
- ☐ Acts 4:13
  "When they saw the boldness of Peter and John and realized that they were unschooled, ordinary men, they marveled and took note that these men had been with Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Gifts and help: Each week, note one strength used and one help sought.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God chose the weak things of the world.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List strengths. Write ten things you do well.
- [ ] Find your learning style. Try listening, pictures, or hands-on work.
- [ ] Ask for help. Tutors, coaches, or evaluators.
- [ ] Memorize 1 Corinthians 1:27. Say it when you feel dumb.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm dumb": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Gifts and help
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm dumb.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have been called dumb for so long. Show me my gifts, lead me to help that fits, and heal old wounds. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I'll always be behind everyone else."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Being the last to finish, needing extra help, or taking longer can make us feel in a permanent race we cannot win. Comparison drains energy and joy.

What Scripture teaches

"Let us run with endurance the race set out for us" (Hebrews 12:1). It is our race, not someone else's. "The race is not to the swift" (Ecclesiastes 9:11). "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up." Each person has a different path and pace. God is concerned with faithfulness, not speed, and He rejoices in your steps.

> *"Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us throw off every encumbrance and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with endurance the race set out for us"* (Hebrews 12:1).

Also see

> "I saw something else under the sun: The race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong; neither is the bread to the wise, nor the wealth to the intelligent, nor the favor to the skillful. For time and chance happen to all" (Ecclesiastes 9:11).

> "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up" (Galatians 6:9).

> "Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else" (Galatians 6:4).

> "The steps of a man are ordered by the LORD who takes delight in his journey" (Psalm 37:23).

Common self-statements

- Everyone passes me.
- I will never catch up.
- I am always last.
- They finish before I start.
- I am slow at everything.
- There is no use.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either ahead or behind.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never catch up.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling slow and concluding I am behind in life.
- Social comparison: Calling myself behind.

Challenging questions

- Who am I comparing myself to, and why?

- What progress have I made compared with myself last year?
- What areas am I not behind in?
- What is a reasonable pace for me?
- What does Scripture say about running my own race?
- Whom can I walk with at my pace?

Truth summary

> I am running my own race, at my own pace, with God's help. Progress matters more than comparison, and faithfulness matters more than speed.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Envy/Jealousy
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Dissatisfaction
- Humility
- Faith

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll always be behind everyone else"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll always be behind everyone else." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who am I comparing myself to, and why?
- ☐ What progress have I made compared with myself last year?
- ☐ What areas am I not behind in?
- ☐ What is a reasonable pace for me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about running my own race?
- ☐ Whom can I walk with at my pace?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I run my own race.
- ☐ The race is not just to the swift.
- ☐ I will not grow weary.
- ☐ Progress counts.
- ☐ God delights in my steps.
- ☐ I can walk with others.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Hebrews 12:1**
  "Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us throw off every encumbrance and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with endurance the race set out for us."
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 9:11**
  "I saw something else under the sun: The race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong; neither is the bread to the wise, nor the wealth to the intelligent, nor the favor to the skillful. For time and chance happen to all."
- ☐ **Galatians 6:9**
  "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] My pace: Each week, note one improvement from last month.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Hebrews 12:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will run with endurance the race set out for me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Envy/Jealousy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Compare with yourself. Write one thing better than last year.
- [ ] Set a pace. Choose a realistic goal.
- [ ] Find a companion. Walk with someone at your pace.
- [ ] Read Hebrews 12:1. Run your race.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll always be behind everyone else": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	My pace
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll always be behind everyone else.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel behind. Help me run my race at my pace, grateful for progress, and free from comparison. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“Why try? I can never succeed.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Repeated failure at school, work, or tasks teaches that effort leads nowhere. Learned helplessness protects us from disappointment but also from growth.

What Scripture teaches

“I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength.” “The LORD is my strength and my song, and He has become my salvation.” “Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men” (Colossians 3:23). Success is not only measured by grades or speed. Each honest effort, each step forward, matters to God. Choose small, achievable goals and celebrate them.

> *“I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength”* (Philippians 4:13).

Also see

> “The LORD is my strength and my song, and He has become my salvation” (Psalm 118:14).
>
> “Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men” (Colossians 3:23).
>
> “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up” (Galatians 6:9).
>
> “Anxiety weighs down the heart of a man, but a good word cheers it up” (Proverbs 12:25).

Common self-statements

- Nothing I do works.
- Trying only leads to failure.
- I give up.
- Others succeed, not me.
- I was not made for this.
- It is safer not to try.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I either succeed fully or fail.
- Fortune telling: Predicting failure.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling defeated and concluding it is pointless.
- Overgeneralizing: Calling myself a failure.

Challenging questions

- When have I succeeded, even in something small?
- What helped then?
- What would a tiny, achievable goal look like?
- Who could help me?
- What does Scripture say about strength?
- How can I define success differently?

Truth summary

> Success includes honest effort and small steps. With Christ's strength and the right help, I can try again and grow, and God honors faithfulness.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Laziness
- Faith
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Strength

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Why try? I can never succeed"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Why try? I can never succeed." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When have I succeeded, even in something small?
- ☐ What helped then?
- ☐ What would a tiny, achievable goal look like?
- ☐ Who could help me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about strength?
- ☐ How can I define success differently?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I can do all things through Christ.
- ☐ The Lord is my strength.
- ☐ I work for the Lord.
- ☐ Small steps count.
- ☐ I will not grow weary.
- ☐ Encouragement helps.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Philippians 4:13
  "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."
- ☐ Psalm 118:14
  "The LORD is my strength and my song, and He has become my salvation."
- ☐ Colossians 3:23
  "Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Small wins: Each week, note one small win.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Philippians 4:13 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ List past wins. Write times you succeeded.
- ☐ Set a tiny goal. Make it achievable.
- ☐ Celebrate. Tell someone about the win.
- ☐ Get help. Ask a tutor, coach, or friend.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Why try? I can never succeed": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Small wins
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Why try? I can never succeed.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am tired of failing. Give me strength for small steps, patient helpers, and joy in honest effort. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I'm a disappointment to my parents."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When grades or milestones are lower than a parent hoped, children can sense disappointment, spoken or not. As adults, they may still hear it, and some parents did say hurtful things.

What Scripture teaches

"Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me." "Before I formed you in the womb I knew you." "Can a woman forget her nursing child…? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you!" God's view of you is not shaped by anyone's expectations. Honor your parents, grieve what hurt, and let your Heavenly Father define you. Many parents also change and learn to see their child's strengths.

> *"Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me"* (Psalm 27:10).

Also see

> "'Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.'" (Jeremiah 1:5).

> "'Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you!'" (Isaiah 49:15).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "'Honor your father and mother' (which is the first commandment with a promise)" (Ephesians 6:2).

Common self-statements

- I let them down.
- They wanted a different child.
- I never met their expectations.
- They are ashamed of me.
- I will never make them proud.
- I am a failure to them.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either a pride or a disappointment.
- Fortune telling: Predicting they will never accept me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling their disappointment and concluding I am one.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a disappointment.

Challenging questions

- What did my parents actually say, and what did I assume?
- What do I wish they could see?
- What are my parents' own fears or hopes?
- What does God say about me?

- Is it possible to talk with them?
- How can I honor them while defining myself differently?

Truth summary

> My worth is not set by my parents' approval. God received me, knew me, and loves me. I can honor my parents, speak honestly if possible, and let God define me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Parenting
- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, All Loving
- Forgiveness
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm a disappointment to my parents"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm a disappointment to my parents." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did my parents actually say, and what did I assume?
- ☐ What do I wish they could see?
- ☐ What are my parents' own fears or hopes?
- ☐ What does God say about me?
- ☐ Is it possible to talk with them?
- ☐ How can I honor them while defining myself differently?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord receives me.
- ☐ He knew me before I was born.
- ☐ He will not forget me.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ I can honor my parents.
- ☐ I am loved.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 27:10
  "Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me."
- ☐ Jeremiah 1:5
  "'Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.'"
- ☐ Isaiah 49:15
  "'Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you!'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Defined by God: Each week, note one thing God says about you.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 27:10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord receives me and knew me before I was born.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Write what you heard. Separate fact from assumption.
- [ ] Share with a counselor. Work through the hurt.
- [ ] Consider a conversation. Only if safe and helpful.
- [ ] Read Psalm 27:10. Remember God receives you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm a disappointment to my parents": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Defined by God
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm a disappointment to my parents.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have felt like a disappointment. Thank You that You receive me. Heal the hurt, and help me honor my parents while resting in Your love. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"Everyone else is better than me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Constant comparison in school, work, and social settings convinces some that they are at the bottom. This belief shrinks risk-taking, friendships, and joy.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, "Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else." "Do not think of yourself more highly than you ought, but think of yourself with sober judgment." And God "has composed the body... so that there should be no division in the body, but that its members should have mutual concern for one another" (1 Corinthians 12:24–25). Different gifts are not better or worse; they are needed. You have your place and your part.

> *"Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else"* (Galatians 6:4).

Also see

> "For by the grace given me I say to every one of you: Do not think of yourself more highly than you ought, but think of yourself with sober judgment, according to the measure of faith God has given you" (Romans 12:3).

> "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable" (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> "Just as each of us has one body with many members, and not all members have the same function, so in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another. We have different gifts according to the grace given us. If one's gift is prophecy, let him use it in proportion to his faith" (Romans 12:4–6).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- Everyone is better.
- I do not measure up.
- They are smarter, kinder, and more capable.
- I am at the bottom.
- I have nothing to offer.
- I will always be second-rate.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either best or worst.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be inferior.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling small and concluding that I am.
- Social comparison: Calling myself inferior.

Challenging questions

- Who exactly am I comparing myself to?

- What do I not see about their struggles?
- What gifts do I have that others lack?
- What do I contribute?
- What does Scripture say about each member of the body?
- Who values me?

Truth summary

> Everyone has different gifts, and mine are needed. I can test my own work, thank God for others' strengths, and be at peace with my own.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Envy/Jealousy
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride
- Humility
- Gifts, Physical/Material

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Everyone else is better than me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Everyone else is better than me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who exactly am I comparing myself to?
- ☐ What do I not see about their struggles?
- ☐ What gifts do I have that others lack?
- ☐ What do I contribute?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about each member of the body?
- ☐ Who values me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I test my own work.
- ☐ Different gifts are needed.
- ☐ Weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ I do not need to compare.
- ☐ I have a place.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:4
  "Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else."
- ☐ Romans 12:3
  "For by the grace given me I say to every one of you: Do not think of yourself more highly than you ought, but think of yourself with sober judgment, according to the measure of faith God has given you."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

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PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] My part: Each week, note one contribution you made.
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  For example, Galatians 6:4 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Everyone has different gifts, and mine are needed.""
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These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your gifts. Write what you offer.
- [ ] Stop one comparison. Limit what feeds it.
- [ ] Thank someone. Appreciate another's strength.
- [ ] Read Romans 12:4–6. See the body at work.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Everyone else is better than me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I compare myself and feel small. Show me my gifts, free me from comparison, and let me enjoy my part in Your body. Amen.

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